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SECOND GREEN REVOLUTION What the States Need to Do

"We need to produce more from the same land with less water"

I am extremely happy to note that this year, India Today State of the States Conclave has decided to keep agriculture at the top of its agenda. The topic, "Second Green Revolution: What the States Need to Do", is extremely appropriate though I would modify it slightly to read "Second Green Revolution: What the Nation Needs to Do".

In the context of rising food and nutritional requirements of our growing population, increased economic growth, recent global food crisis and the adverse impacts of climatic vari-

ability on agricultural production, the need for a second agricultural revolution is a foregone conclusion. The issue is not whether we do or do not need a second revolution but rather the mechanics of it. The requirement today is to produce more quantities of diversified food in a sustainable manner that mitigates the climatic and commercial risks of the farmers and is adequate to ensure the food security of the nation.

Agriculture has always remained India's most important economic sector. Though its